Lab 1: Your Task Inventory

AI Administrator · Day 1 · Session 1 · Foundations

Participant lab handout

Objective

Produce a one-page inventory of your own recurring tasks, classify each one as automation, workflow with AI step, agent, or keep human, and choose the task you will map, build and control for the rest of the course.

Time: 20 minutes in the session; finish at home. **Due:** before the next session.

What you need

- A blank document or spreadsheet (Google Sheets, Excel, Word, Docs, anything).
- An AI assistant account: ChatGPT, Claude, Microsoft Copilot or Gemini. Nothing to install.
- Ten minutes of honesty about how you actually spend your week.

Steps

1. List ten recurring tasks

Write down ten things you do at least weekly. Be concrete. Not “emails” but “reply to leave requests”, “chase late timesheets”, “update the vendor tracker”, “compile the Monday status report”.

2. Tag each task

Add three columns:

Column	Allowed values
Frequency	daily, weekly, monthly
Minutes per occurrence	a number
Judgement needed	none, some, a lot

3. Classify the design

Add a fourth column, **Design**, with one of: **Automation**, **Workflow with AI step**, **Agent**, **Keep human**.

Use this guide:

If the task…	Then the design is
Needs no judgement; same steps every time (copying, creating, sending, chasing)	Automation
Needs reading or writing with clear rules (classify, summarise, extract, draft)	Workflow with AI step
Is open-ended research or problem-solving where the path is unknown in advance	Agent
Decides about money, people, legal exposure or reputation	Keep human

4. Ask your assistant to challenge you

Paste your table into your AI assistant with this prompt and note where it disagrees with you:

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You are an operations consultant. Here is a table of my recurring tasks with my
proposed
design for each (Automation, Workflow with AI step, Agent, Keep human). For each row,
say
whether you agree, and if not, why. Then rank the top three tasks by time saved per
week.
Be brief.

[paste your table here]
```

Write one line under the table: where did it disagree, and did it change your mind?

5. Pick your course task

Choose **one** task rated *Workflow with AI step* that takes at least 30 minutes a week. Highlight the row. You will map it on Day 2 (Modules 3 and 4), automate it on Day 3 (Modules 5 and 6), and add controls to it on Day 5 (Module 10).

Deliverable

A one-page task inventory: ten rows, four columns (Frequency, Minutes, Judgement, Design), your chosen course task highlighted, and one line about the assistant's challenge. Save it as **M1-task-inventory** in your course folder and bring it to the next session.

Stuck?

- **"Everything I do needs judgement."** Split one task into its steps: read, decide, copy, send, chase. Usually only the *decide* step needs judgement; the rest is automation.
- **"I cannot think of ten tasks."** Open your sent-mail folder for last week. Every recurring subject line is a task.

- **No assistant account?** Pair with a neighbour for step 4. The deliverable is the document, not the chat.

For the instructor: quick rubric

Check	Pass looks like
Ten concrete tasks	Verbs and objects, not categories (“reply to leave requests”, not “emails”)
Tags filled	All three tag columns complete for all ten rows
Designs justified	Keep-human rows involve money, people or law; agent rows are genuinely open-ended
Course task chosen	One *Workflow with AI step* task, 30+ minutes a week, highlighted
Challenge recorded	One line on where the assistant disagreed

Reference: Module 1 online, with the knowledge check scored in the browser: albanna-tutorials.com/ai-administrator/01_agents_and_automation.html